20 APP UX PATTERNS

A practical look at the small decisions behind 20 standout apps — and what to borrow for your own.

INSIDE

01 One clear promise

02 Complex work, simple flow

03 Data that leads to action

04 Accessibility is the experience

05 Delight with a job to do

CURATED 15 OCTOBER 2026

20 PRODUCTS / 5 DESIGN MOVES / 1 WORKING CHECKLIST

Study the move.
Build your own version.

This shortlist is built for founders, designers and app builders. Each case gives you one observable product choice and one idea to test. Open the official listing, inspect the flow, and adapt the principle to your own users.

THE FIVE CHAPTERS

01 **One clear promise**

Make the first useful action obvious.

02 **Complex work, simple flow**

Reveal power after the first result.

03 **Data that leads to action**

Turn information into a next step.

04 **Accessibility is the experience**

Support more ways to complete the task.

05 **Delight with a job to do**

Give personality a practical purpose.

A SIMPLE WAY TO STUDY

1 **Choose one job**

Start with the user task you are actively designing.

2 **Trace the sequence**

Look at entry, action, feedback and next step.

3 **Sketch a transfer**

Use your content and constraints, not their pixels.

4 **Test the result**

Check comprehension and the first successful outcome.

Selection note

Apple and Google editorial selections were discovery signals. The application ideas here are our interpretation; product UI may change.

CHAPTER 01

One Clear Promise

A product can feel generous when its first action is obvious.

grug

Daily wisdom / iOS

OBSERVE

Open, read one thought, leave. Notice the hand-drawn interface and absence of account setup.

APPLY

Reduce the first session to one useful outcome before asking for a profile.

View app > Editorial source >

Focus Friend



Focus timer / Android

OBSERVE

A small character turns a focus session into a reason to put the phone down.

APPLY

Let the reward reinforce the user's real goal, not screen time.

View app > Editorial source >

iA Writer

Writing / iOS

OBSERVE

The editor keeps words central; the library and preview appear when needed.

APPLY

Hide secondary tools until the user is ready to switch tasks.

View app > Editorial source >

Mela



Recipe manager / iOS

OBSERVE

Cooking mode emphasizes the current step while timers remain close at hand.

APPLY

Design around the moment of use, not just the content catalog.

View app > Editorial source >

CHAPTER 02

Complex Work, Simple Flow

Show the result first, then reveal the power underneath.

Detail

AI video editor / iOS

OBSERVE

Camera-like capture leads into silence removal, multi-angle edits and a teleprompter.

APPLY

Give beginners a short path to a finished artifact; keep advanced editing available.

View app > Editorial source >

Moises

Music creation / iOS

OBSERVE

Stem separation becomes a visible, playable set of tracks rather than an abstract AI feature.

APPLY

Make an invisible model output tangible and reversible.

View app > Editorial source >



Capy

Meeting translation / iOS

OBSERVE

A friendly character holds attention while transcription and translation run.

APPLY

Use the waiting state to explain progress; deliver the useful output immediately.

View app > Editorial source >

Edits

Mobile video editor / Android

OBSERVE

Capture, edit and publish live in a creator-oriented mobile workflow.

APPLY

Organize tools in the order of the user's job, not by technical feature type.

View app > Editorial source >

CHAPTER 03

Data That Leads To Action

Great data screens answer 'what should I do next?'.



Structured

Daily planner / iOS

OBSERVE

A scannable timeline makes tasks, free time and breaks visible together.

APPLY

Show capacity and recovery alongside commitments.

View app > Editorial source >



The Outsiders

Athlete tracker / iOS

OBSERVE

Training load, sleep and recovery combine in one readiness view.

APPLY

Translate several metrics into a decision cue, while keeping detail inspectable.

View app > Editorial source >



Tide Guide

Tide and weather / iOS

OBSERVE

Dense forecast data is layered into readable full-screen charts and widgets.

APPLY

Start with the time-sensitive answer; reveal detail on demand.

View app > Editorial source >



Moonlitt

Moon tracker / iOS

OBSERVE

Onboarding and platform-specific views make astronomy approachable.

APPLY

Use a strong visual model to explain a changing natural system.

View app > Editorial source >

CHAPTER 04

Accessibility Is The Experience

Support different people in the primary journey, not as an afterthought.



Hearing Buddy

Live captions / iOS

OBSERVE

Conversation captions and Watch alerts address real listening moments.

APPLY

Put critical information on the device and modality that can reach the user.

View app > Editorial source >



Speechify

Text to audio / iOS

OBSERVE

Documents, scans and web pages become listenable through an approachable interface.

APPLY

Offer alternate input and output modes for the same user task.

View app > Editorial source >



Guitar Wiz

Music utility / iOS

OBSERVE

Spoken chord guidance, Dynamic Type and contrast options support more players.

APPLY

Test the core action with VoiceOver and without relying on color alone.

View app > Editorial source >



Katha Room

Children's stories / iOS

OBSERVE

Folklore-inspired art and sound give familiar bedtime flows a distinct cultural voice.

APPLY

Make the identity of the audience visible in content and interface details.

View app > Editorial source >

CHAPTER 05

Delight With A Job To Do

Personality works best when it supports comprehension and action.



(Not Boring) Camera

Camera / iOS

OBSERVE

Large controls and haptic dials turn settings into a tactile experience.

APPLY

Use distinctive interaction where immediate feedback helps mastery.

View app > Editorial source >



Harvee

Recovery companion / iOS

OBSERVE

A small avatar helps interpret heart-rate, sleep and activity signals.

APPLY

Use a character to humanize a complex state, while keeping the underlying data accessible.

View app > Editorial source >



Pingo AI

Language learning / Android

OBSERVE

Conversation practice makes the learner produce language rather than just browse lessons.

APPLY

Design the learning loop around doing, feedback and another attempt.

View app > Editorial source >



Goodnotes

Notes / Android tablets

OBSERVE

A large-screen canvas supports handwriting, documents and annotation together.

APPLY

Adapt the workspace to the device; do more than stretch a phone layout.

View app > Editorial source >

FROM INSPIRATION TO ACTION

A five-question design review.

Use this after studying an example. If the answer is unclear, sketch another version and test it with a user.

01 **FIRST VALUE**

Can a new user reach one useful outcome in the first minute?

02 **NEXT ACTION**

Does each screen make the next action clear?

03 **USEFUL DATA**

Are complex results translated into a decision or action?

04 **ACCESS**

Can someone complete the core task with assistive settings?

05 **PURPOSEFUL DELIGHT**

Does personality help the task rather than interrupt it?

SOURCES & METHOD

Apple Design Awards 2025 and 2026; Google Play Best of 2025; official store listings. Open the links on each case to verify details. Independent editorial selection; no product affiliation.